

safer sex

Sex using different methods, including barrier contraception, to protect against STDs and pregnancy.

scrotum

The skin sack containing the testicles.

search engine

A computer program which searches a database for information based on keywords typed in by the user.

self-confidence

A person's general trust and belief in their own abilities and judgments.

self-consciousness

A person's awkward awareness and worry over how others might perceive them.

self-esteem

An person's inner sense of self-worth, which can affect their self-confidence.

self-expression

The assertion of identity through certain behaviors or actions.

selfie

A self-portrait taken with a smartphone.

sensationalization

The exaggerated presentation of information to suggest that it is more shocking than it is in reality, in order to stimulate interest.

sex

An act of physical intimacy between two people. Also used to mean biological sex.

sexism

Discrimination or prejudice against an individual or group due to their biological sex.

sext

A naked, underwear-only, or sexually explicit picture or video message sent by the taker to another person. Also called nude selfie.

sexual identity

A person's perception of who they are attracted to.

sexual reproduction

When a male sperm and female egg join, and the chromosomes carried by each mix to produce a child.

sexuality

The interaction between a person's desires, preferences, experiences, and beliefs throughout their life.

sexually transmitted disease (STD)

A disease that can be passed from one person to another through sex.

sibling

The relationship between two children who share one or both parents.

social conscience

Having a sense of responsibility and concern for the general well-being and fair treatment of others in a society.

social norm

Unwritten rules and behaviors that are generally considered acceptable by society.

spam

Unwanted emails, messages, or ads that are sometimes used for spreading malware.

spirituality

A personal sense that something exists—such as a person's spirit or soul—beyond the physical being. Spirituality is an aspect of religious faith, but it is different from religion.

stereotype

A prevailing and oversimplified idea that is often prejudicial about a person or group.

stigma

A sense of shame due to having a certain characteristic.

stimulant

A substance that increases a person's energy or other body function. Caffeine is a stimulant, as are many other drugs.

stimulation

Something that causes something else to happen.

straight

A person that is sexually attracted to members of the opposite sex; also known as heterosexual.

stress

A feeling of worry or tension when faced with a problem, or something that causes this.

synapse

The connection between two nerve or brain cells, through which chemical signals are passed.

testicles

The two male sex glands that produce and store sperm. They are located in the scrotum.

transgender

When a person's gender identity as a man or woman is mismatched with the sex they were assigned at birth; the opposite of cisgender.

trolling

Inflammatory and offensive comments posted online with the intent to cause upset and provoke reactions.

trust

An assured confidence in someone or something.

tween

An individual who is between childhood and puberty.

United Nations (UN)

An international organization formed in 1945 to promote international cooperation, of which most of the world's countries are members.

uterus

An organ in a female's lower abdomen in which embryos develop and grow. Also known as the womb.

vaccination

The injection of a harmless version of an infection into a person to stimulate the immune system to protect them against that infection.

vagina

In females, the muscular passage between the internal sex organs and the external genitals.

virginity

The state of not having had sexual intercourse with another person.

virus

A disease-causing, nonliving microorganism that invades a cell and produces copies of itself that then invade other cells. Also describes computer programs that cause harm to computer systems.

vulva

The external parts of a female's genitals that make up the opening to the vagina.

webcam

A digital camera that allows images or videos to be transmitted over the Internet through a computer.